```
        // Handle API exceptions: if the request expects JSON, return a custom JSON response.
    if ($request->wantsJson()) {
            return response()->json([
                'success' => false,
                'message' => 'An error occurred.',
                'error'   => $exception->getMessage()
            ], 500);
    }

        // For web requests, return the default error view with relevant status code.
    return parent::render($request, $exception);
}
```